

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Sunday, July 19, 2026

Edition No. 9

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

ECONOMY

Federal Reserve Signals Possible Interest Rate Increase

The Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) has indicated that it may raise interest rates for the first time since 2023. This news comes as the economy faces ongoing challenges and rising prices, known as inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time). The potential increase in rates could

impact borrowing costs for everyday people, affecting loans for homes, cars, and credit cards.

If rates go up, it might become more expensive to borrow money, which could slow down spending and investment. This is important for everyone, as it could influence job growth and the overall economy.

Source: Fortius Intel

MARKETS

S&P 500 Falls Due to Geopolitical Tensions and Semiconductor Weakness

The S&P 500 (an index that tracks the stock prices of 500 large U.S. companies) dropped as geopolitical tensions rose following a blockade on Iranian shipping. This situation has caused uncertainty in the markets, affecting stock prices. Additionally, the semiconductor sector, which produces computer chips, faced challenges, leading to significant losses for companies like SK Hynix.

This decline in the stock market can impact everyday people, as it may affect retirement accounts and investments. A falling market can lead to less confidence in the economy, which could influence spending and job growth.

Source: The Financial Express

IBM Shares Drop Over 20% Before Earnings Report

IBM's stock price fell by more than 20% just days before the company was set to release its earnings report, which shows how much money the company made. This sharp decline was due to concerns about lower-than-expected revenue from its infrastructure services, which are essential for businesses. Investors are worried about IBM's financial health, which can impact its ability to invest in new technologies.

This situation is important for everyday people because it highlights how the performance of large companies can affect job security and technological advancements that we rely on.

Source: The Financial Express

U.S. Ends Waiver Allowing Iranian Oil Sales After Attacks

The U.S. government has revoked a waiver that allowed Iran to sell oil, following attacks on tankers in the Strait of Hormuz. This decision is intended to cut off a significant source of revenue for Iran amid rising tensions in the region. Oil prices could be affected by this move, which may lead to higher costs for consumers at the gas pump.

This situation is important for everyday people because fluctuations in oil prices can directly impact transportation costs and overall living expenses.

Source: CBS News

COMPANIES

PNC Financial Services Raises Dividend by 18% for Shareholders

PNC Financial Services Group has announced an 18% increase in its quarterly cash dividend, raising it to \$2.00 per share. A dividend is a payment made to shareholders from a company's profits. This increase reflects the company's strong financial performance and is a positive sign for investors.

This news is important for everyday people because it indicates the financial health of a company, which can affect job security and investment opportunities.

Source: Investing.com

JPMorgan Chase Reports Strong Earnings with \$21.2 Billion Net Income

JPMorgan Chase has reported a net income of \$21.2 billion for the second quarter of 2026, which means the company made this amount after all expenses. This strong financial performance is attributed to its diversified business model and effective risk management strategies. This news is significant as it reflects the health of one of the largest banks in the U.S.

This information is important for everyday people because the performance of large banks can influence lending practices and the overall economy.

Source: MarketScreener India

FEATURE

EXPLAINER OF THE DAY

Understanding the Strait of Hormuz and Its Importance to Oil Supply

The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow waterway that connects the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman, and it is crucial for global oil transportation. Approximately 20% of the world's oil passes through this strait daily. Recent geopolitical tensions have raised concerns about potential disruptions in oil supply, which could lead to higher prices for consumers.

This information is important for everyday people because fluctuations in oil supply can directly impact gas prices and overall living costs.

Source: CBS News

